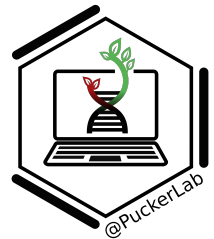
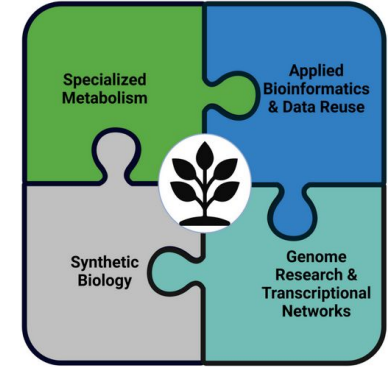


Prof. Dr. Boas Pucker

Introduction to Plant Bioinformatics

- Name?
- Study program?
- Semester?
- Previous experiences with biochemistry?
- Previous experiences with bioinformatics?
- Expectations?

- Biochemistry at HHU Düsseldorf
- (Systems) Biology at Bielefeld University
- Doctoral student (CeBiTec, Bielefeld University)
 - Genomics & Bioinformatics; synthetic biology (iGEM)
- Post doc (Ruhr-University Bochum)
- Post doc (Department of Plant Sciences, Cambridge, UK)
- Plant Biotechnology & Bioinformatics, TU Braunschweig (2021-2025)
 - Specialized plant metabolites, applied bioinformatics
- University of Bonn (since 2025): Plant Biotechnology & Bioinformatics



Availability of slides

- All materials are freely available (CC BY) - after the lectures:
 - eCampus: WBIO-A-08
 - GitHub: <https://github.com/bpucker/teaching>
- Questions: Feel free to ask at any time
- Feedback, comments, or questions: [pucker\[a\]uni-bonn.de](mailto:pucker[a]uni-bonn.de)



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BASIS today!!!**

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- 1) Introduction to bioinformatics (today)
- 2) Identification of biosynthesis pathways
- 3) Pathway databases
- 4) Gene expression & co-expression analyses
- 5) Phylogenetic analyses
- 6) Synteny & biosynthetic gene clusters
- 7) Metabolic flux & modeling
- 8) Repetition, questions & quiz

- Suggestions for detailed literature will be included on slides
- DOI = Digital Object Identifier
- Unique and short way to point to a publication
- How to resolve a DOI? <https://dx.doi.org/>



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Resolve a DOI Name

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bioRxiv posts many COVID-19 related papers. A reminder: they have not been formally peer-reviewed and should not guide health-related behavior or be reported in the press as conclusive.

New Results [Follow this preprint](#)

Apicaceae FNS / originated from F3H through tandem gene duplication

Boas Pucker, Massimo Jorizzo
doi: <https://doi.org/10.1101/2022.02.16.480750>
This preprint reports new research that has not been certified by peer review (what does this mean?).

[Abstract](#) [Full Text](#) [Info/History](#) [Metrics](#) [Preview PDF](#)

Abstract

Background Flavonoids are specialized metabolites with numerous biological functions in stress response and reproduction of plants. Flavones are one subgroup that is produced by the flavone synthase (FNS). Two distinct enzyme families evolved that can catalyze the biosynthesis of flavones. While the membrane-bound FNS I is widely distributed in seed plants, one lineage of soluble FNS I appeared to be unique to Apicaceae species.

Results We show through phylogenetic and comparative genomic analyses that Apicaceae FNS I evolved through tandem gene duplication of flavone 3-hydroxylase (F3H) followed by neofunctionalization. Currently available datasets suggest that this event happened within the Apicaceae in a common ancestor of *Daucus carota* and *Apium graveolens*. The results also support previous findings that FNS I in the Apicaceae evolved independent of FNS I in other plant species.

Conclusion We validated a long standing hypothesis about the evolution of Apicaceae FNS I and predicted the phylogenetic position of this event. Our results explain how an Apicaceae-specific FNS I lineage evolved and confirm independence from other FNS I lineages reported in non-Apicaceae species.

Competing Interest Statement

The authors have declared no competing interest.

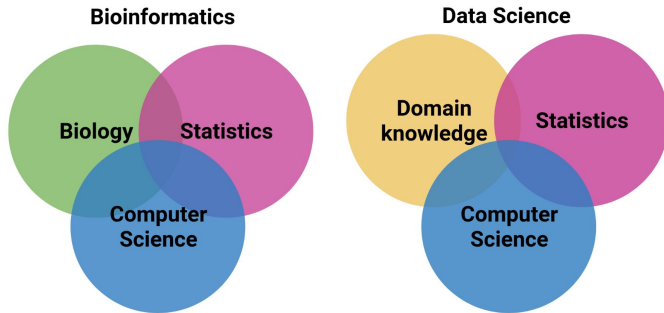
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What is bioinformatics?



What is bioinformatics?

- Subdiscipline of biology, statistics, and computer science
- Acquisition, storage, analysis, and dissemination of biological data
- Bioinformatics is a biology-specific data science version

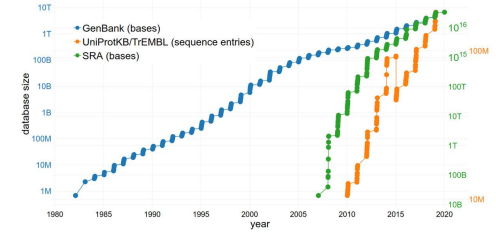


Why do we need bioinformatics?

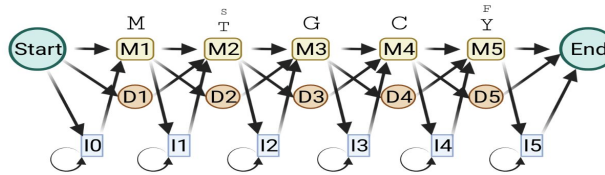


Why do we need bioinformatics?

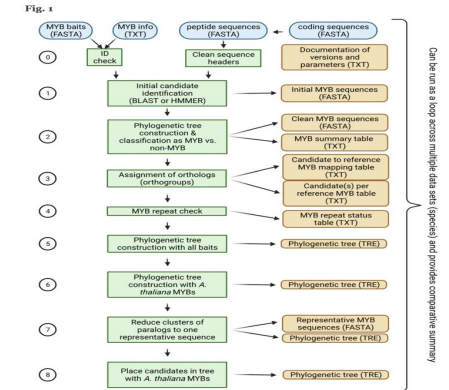
- Large data sets



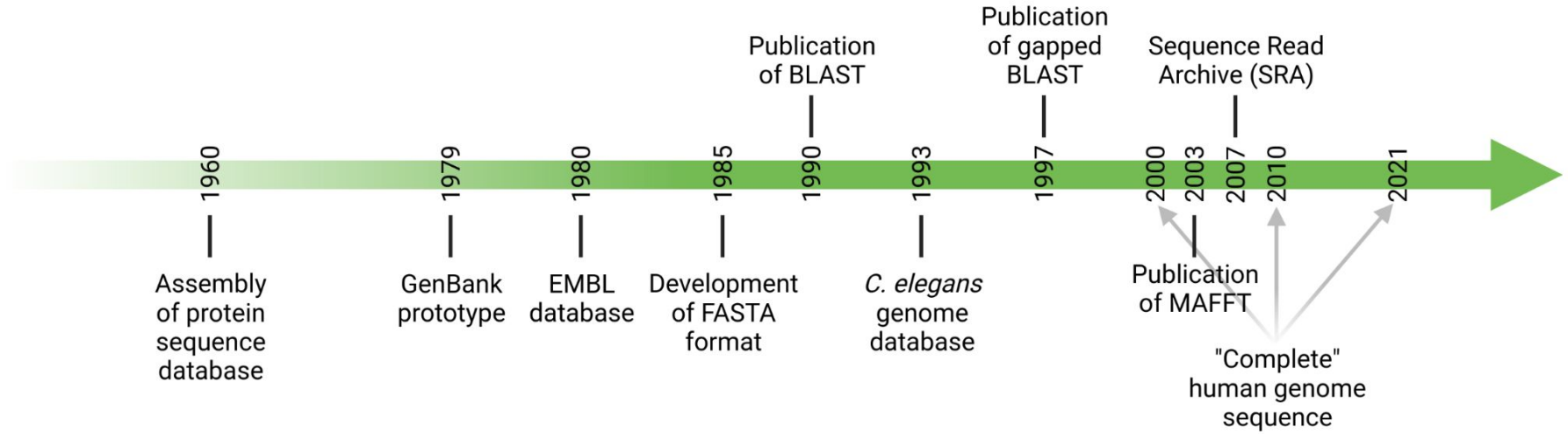
- Complex models



- Automatic analyses



History of bioinformatics

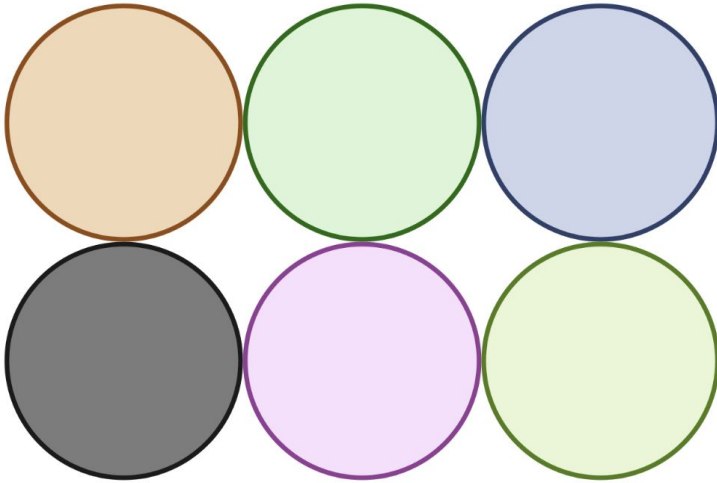


- Experience with ChatGPT (OpenAI)?
- Do you see potential and risk?
- AI does not only work for text, but also for code, images, movies, games, gene prediction, pattern recognition, but there are limitations!!!

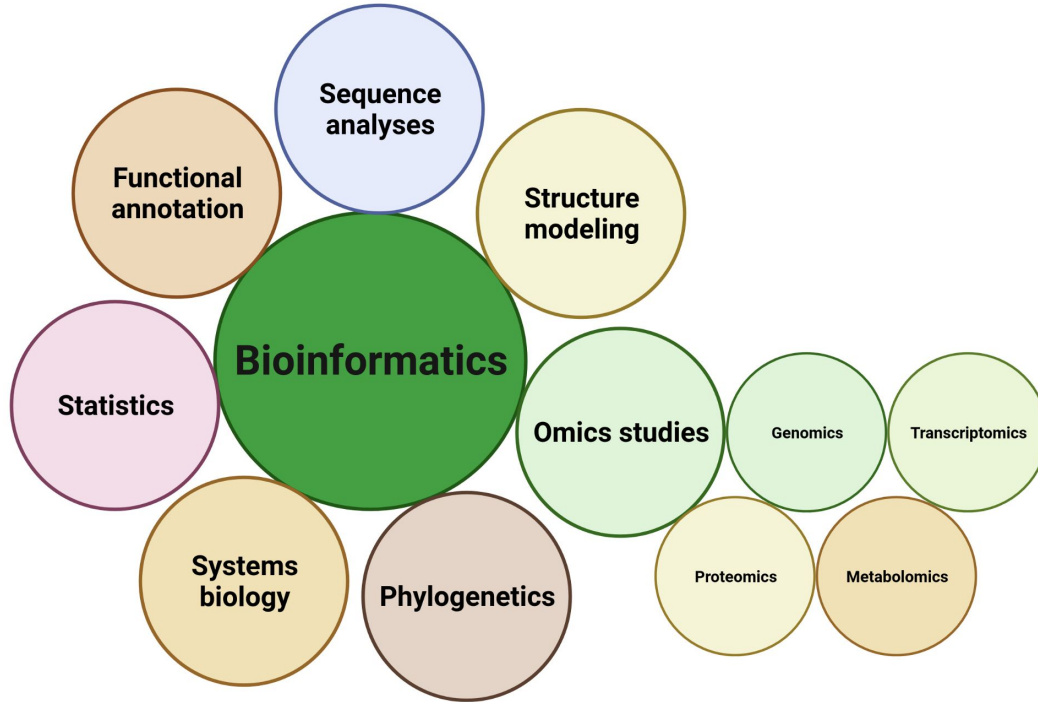
Future Reading & Related Work (selected publications from the Pucker Lab):

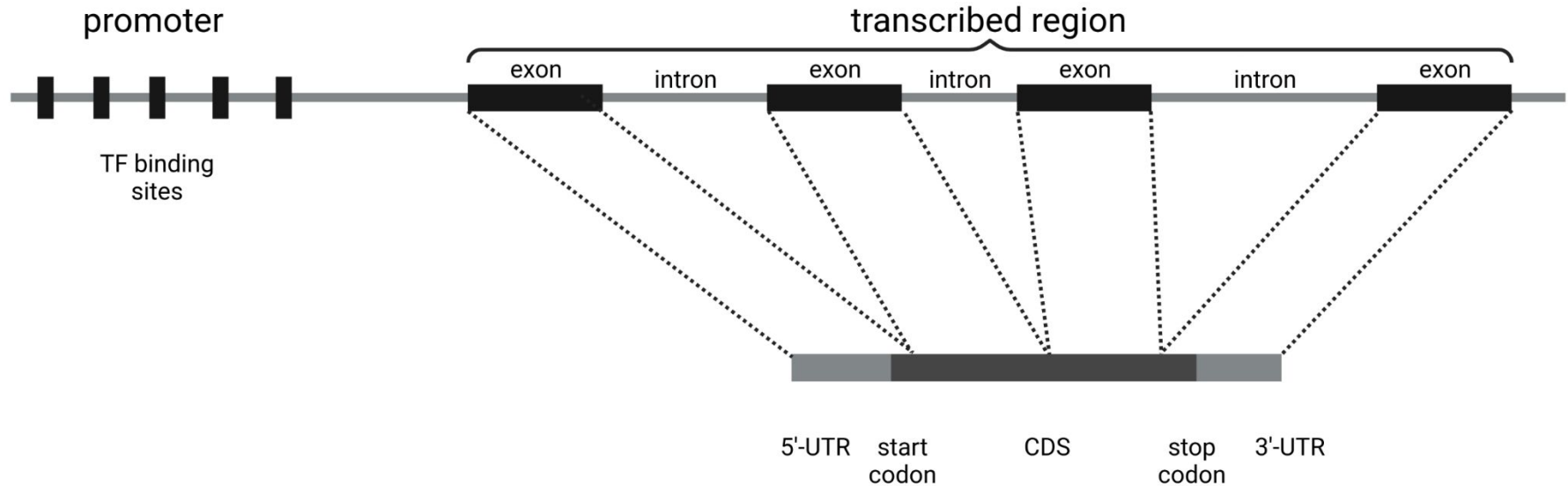
1. **Pucker, B. et al. (2024).** "A comprehensive survey of anthocyanin pathway disruptions in diverse plant species." *BMC Plant Biology*, 24, 5316. <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12870-024-05316-w>
2. **Pucker, B. et al. (2021).** "Automatic identification of genes with loss-of-function mutations in plant pigment biosynthesis pathways." *Genes*, 12(3), 452.
3. **Pucker, B., & Brockington, S. F. (2022).** "Insights into the evolution of pigment pathways from comparative genomics of Caryophyllales." *Frontiers in Plant Science*, 13, 870263.

What are the different (sub)fields of bioinformatics?



What are the different (sub)fields of bioinformatics?





- Comparison of sequences to find similarities
- Analysis of sequence composition
- Important methods:
 - BLAST = Basic Local Alignment Search Tool
 - MAFFT = Multiple Alignment using Fast Fourier Transform

chalcone synthase [Chenopodium quinoa]

Sequence ID: [XP_021762431.1](#) Length: 392 Number of Matches: 1

Range: 1 to 389 [GenPept](#) [Graphics](#) [Next Match](#) [Previous Match](#)

Score	Expect	Method	Identities	Positives	Gaps
666 bits(1719)	0.0	Compositional matrix adjust.	323/388(83%)	362/388(93%)	0/388(0%)
Query 3					62
Sbjct 2					61
Query 63					122
Sbjct 62					121
Query 123					182
Sbjct 122					181
Query 183					242
Sbjct 182					241
Query 243					302
Sbjct 242					301
Query 303					362
Sbjct 302					361
Query 363					390
Sbjct 362					389

CLUSTAL format alignment by MAFFT FFT-NS-i (v7.487)

```

BvCHS      M---ATPSVQEIADQSRNGPATILAIGTANPANEMYQAEYPDFYFRVTKSEHMKELKOK
AtCHS      MVMAGASSLDEIRQAQRADGPAGILAIGTANPENHVLOAEYPDYFRITNSEHMTDLKEK
          *  . : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : :
          *  . : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : :

BvCHS      FKRMCDNSMIKKRYMHVTEELLENPHLCDFNASSLDTRODILATEVPLKGEAAVKAIA
AtCHS      FKRMCDKSTIRKRMHMLEEFLKENPHMCAYMAPSLDTRODIVVEVPLKGEAAVKAIA
          *  * : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : :
          *  * : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : :

BvCHS      EWGQPRSKITHVIFCTTSGVDMPGADYQTLKLLGLRPSVKRFMLYQQGCFAGGTVLR
AtCHS      EWGQPKSKITHVVFCTTSGVDMPGADYQTLKLLGLRPSVKRLMMYQQGCFAGGTVLR
          *  * : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : :
          *  * : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : :

BvCHS      DIAENNRGARVLVCAEITIIICFRGPTQIHLDSMVGQALFGDGAGAVIGADPDESI-ER
AtCHS      DLAEENNRGARVLVVCSEITAVTFRGPDTHLDSLVGQALFSDGAAALIVGSDPDTSVGEK
          *  * : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : :
          *  * : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : :

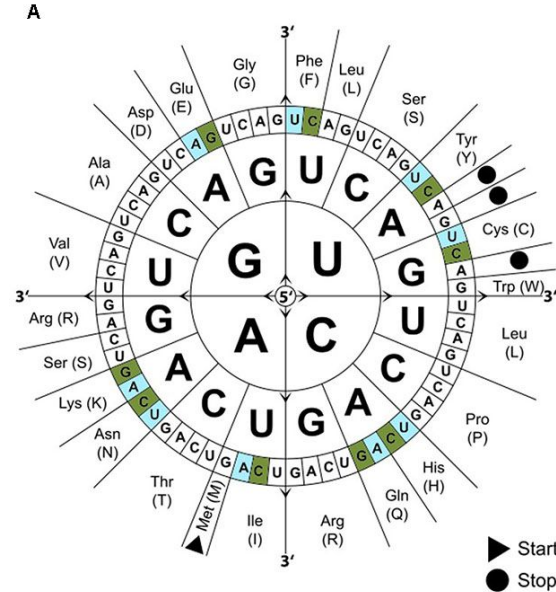
BvCHS      PTFQVWAAQTILPGSEGAIDGHLREVGLTFHLLKQDVPGLISKNIKALVEAFQPIGIDD
AtCHS      PIFEMVAAQTILPDSGAIIDGHLREVGLTFHLLKQDVPGLISKNIKSLDEAFKPLGISD
          *  * : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : :
          *  * : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : :

BvCHS      WNSIFWVAHPGGRAILDQVEKSLGLKEDKLTTRHVLSEYGNMSSACVLFILDEMRKRAM
AtCHS      WNSLFWIAHPGGPAILDQVEKSLGLKEDKMRATRHVLSEYGNMSSACVLFILDEMRKRAM
          *  * : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : :
          *  * : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : :

BvCHS      KEGMATTGEGLEWGLVFGFGPGLTVETVMLHVSPTAN
AtCHS      KDGWATTGEGLEWGLVFGFGPGLTVETVMLHVSPL--
          *  * : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : :
          *  * : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : : :

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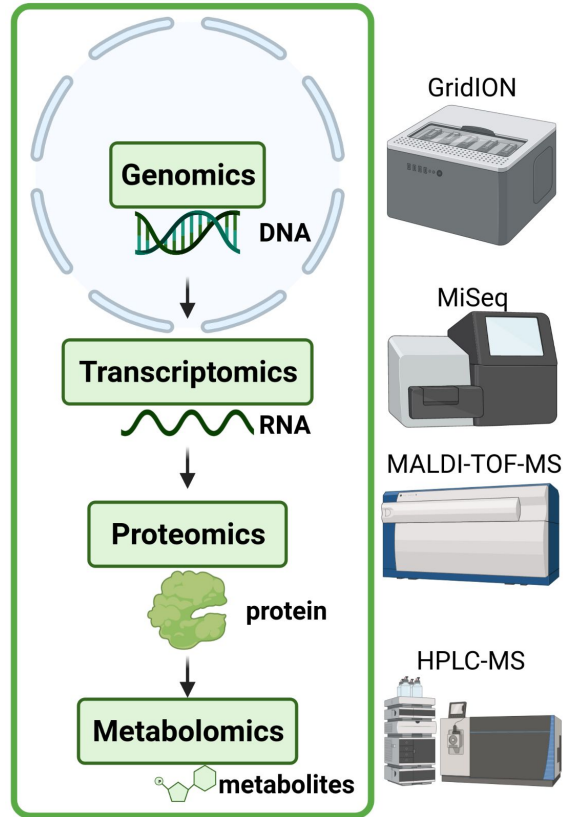

- Codons define amino acids to integrate
- Genetic code is redundant i.e. multiple codons for each amino acid
- Organisms can have a preference for certain codons for a given amino acid
- Optimization of sequences for heterologous expression



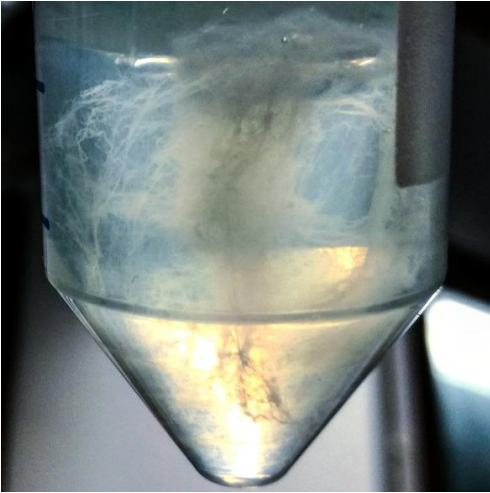
B

Amino acid	Codon	<i>P. patens</i>	<i>A. thaliana</i>	<i>S. cerevisiae</i>	<i>S. pombe</i>	<i>H. sapiens</i>
Cys	UGC	++	-	+	+	+
	UGU	-	-	+	-	-
Glu	GAA	-	-	+	-	-
	GAG	++	-	+	+	+
Phe	UUC	++	+	+	+	+
	UUU	-	-	+	-	-
His	CAC	++	+	+	+	+
	CAU	-	-	-	-	-
Ile	AUA	-	-	/	-	-
	AUC	++	/	-	+	+
	AUU	-	-	-	-	-
Lys	AAA	-	-	-	-	-
	AAG	++	+	+	+	+
Asn	AAC	++	+	+	+	+
	AAU	-	-	-	-	-
Gln	CAA	-	-	-	+	-
	CAG	++	+	+	-	+
Tyr	UAC	++	+	+	+	+
	UAU	-	-	-	-	-

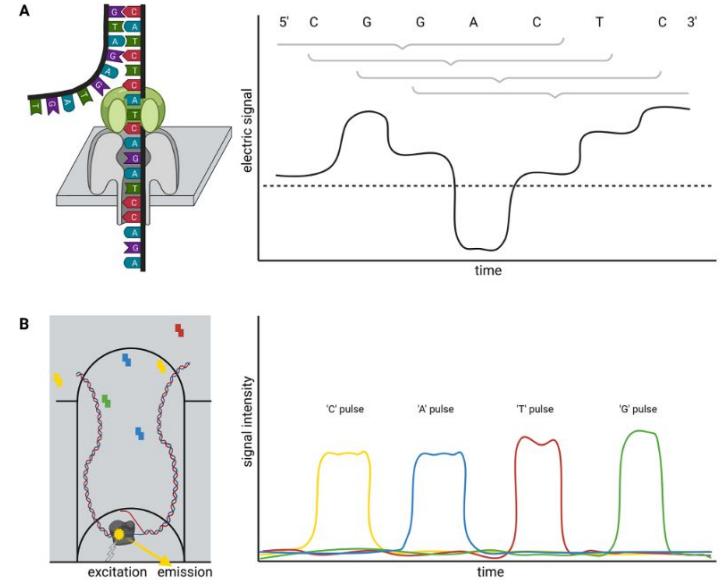
Omics levels



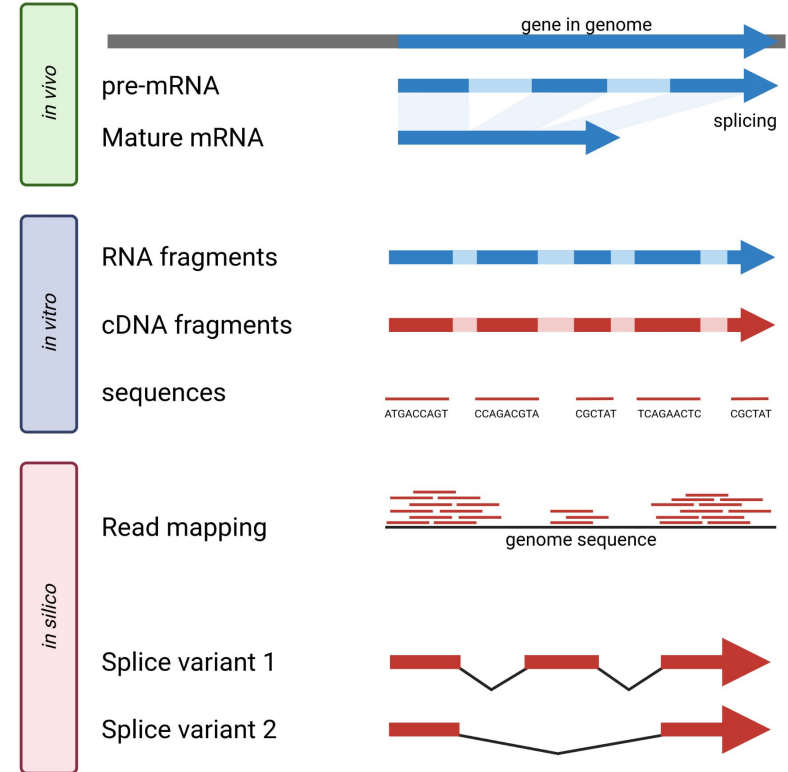
What is a genome?



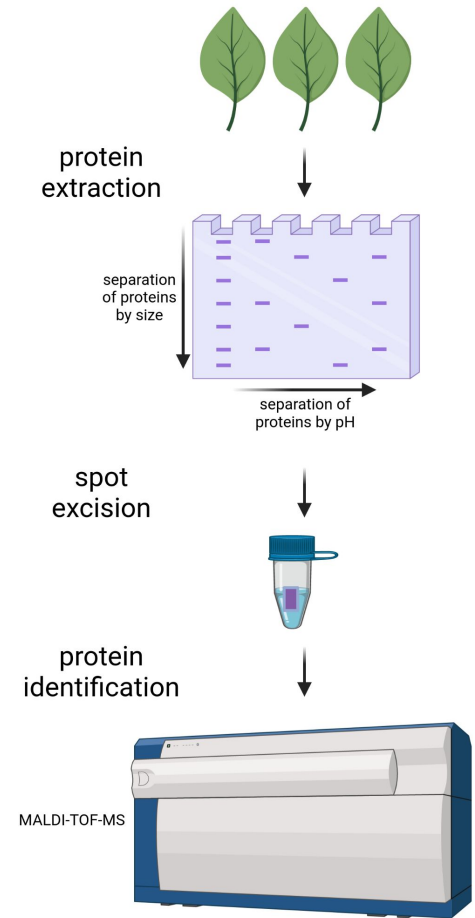
- Genome = sum all of genetic information in a cell
- Plants have DNA in nucleus (nucleome), chloroplasts (plastome), and mitochondria (chondromes)
- Sequencing plant genomes: Oxford Nanopore Technologies (ONT) and Pacific Biosciences (PacBio)
- Genome sequence assembly: HiCanu, FALCON, Shasta, NextDenovo2 ...
- Comparison of genome sequences
- Handling of large data sets (>1TB) necessary for most projects



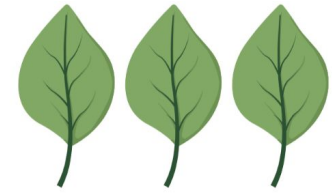
- Transcriptome = sum of transcripts in a cell/tissue under defined conditions and at a defined time point
- Systematic investigation of gene expression:
 - Microarrays: method of choice for many years
 - RNA-Seq: current method of choice to study gene expression systematically
- Comparison of different samples (tissues, conditions, genotypes,)



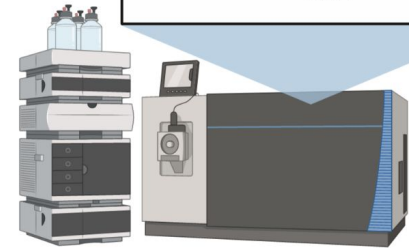
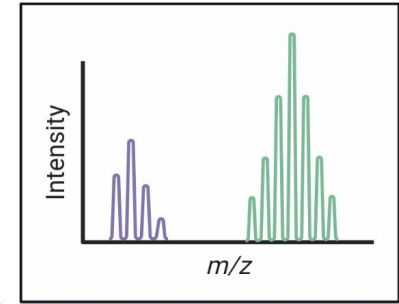
- Proteome = sum of all proteins in a cell/tissue under defined conditions at a defined time point
- Methods for systematic investigation:
 - High Performance Liquid Chromatography (HPLC)-Mass Spectrometry (MS)
 - Separation of proteins via 2D gels and investigation of spots by MS
- Heterogenous properties of proteins make systematic analysis challenging



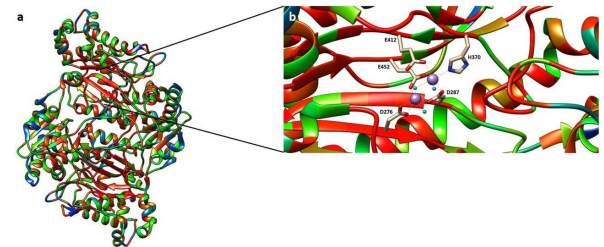
- Metabolom = sum all of metabolites in a cell/tissue under defined conditions at a defined time point
- Methods for systematic metabolite analysis:
 - HPLC-MS/MS
 - GC-MS/MS
- Chemical diversity of metabolites poses a challenge for the analysis
- Identification of metabolites remains a challenge



extraction of
metabolites



- Modeling of RNA structures
 - Collection of tools: https://molbiol-tools.ca/RNA_analysis.htm
 - BiBiServ: <https://bibiserv.cebitec.uni-bielefeld.de/rna>
 - RNAfold:
<http://rna.tbi.univie.ac.at/cgi-bin/RNAWebSuite/RNAfold.cgi>
- Modeling of 3D protein structures
 - Collection of tools:
https://molbiol-tools.ca/Protein_tertiary_structure.htm
 - PredictProtein: <https://predictprotein.org/>
 - AlphaFold2 (10.1021/acs.jcim.1c01114)



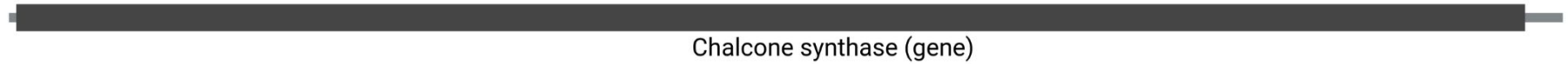
Structural vs. functional annotation

- Structural annotation = position of features (e.g. exons) in a genome sequence
- Functional annotation = biochemical function of a feature (e.g. gene)

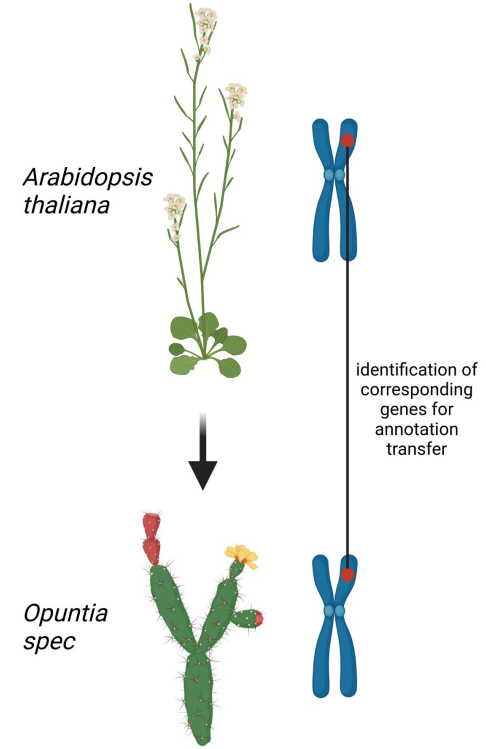
Structural annotation



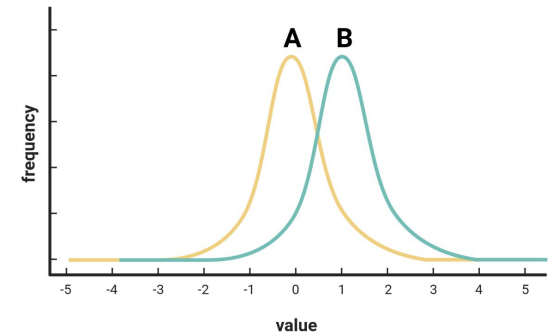
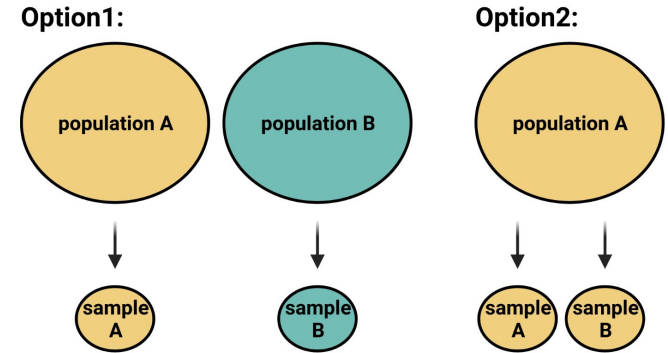
Functional annotation



- Assumption: similar sequences (genes) have similar functions
- Sequence similarity indicates origin from a shared common ancestor
- Ancestor is likely to have inherited the same function to offspring
- Transfer of functional annotation based on sequence similarity
- *Arabidopsis thaliana* gene functions are well studied and usually serve as reference

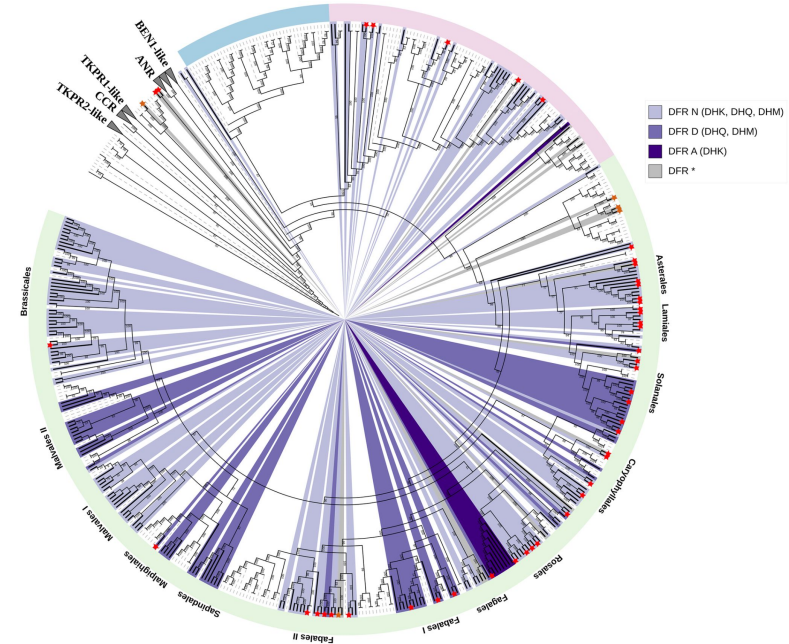


- Statistical tests to assess data sets
- Important for analysis of omics data sets
- Concept of a statistical test:
 - H_0 = difference of two samples can be explained by random effects
 - H_1 = certain factor(s) determine the difference of groups

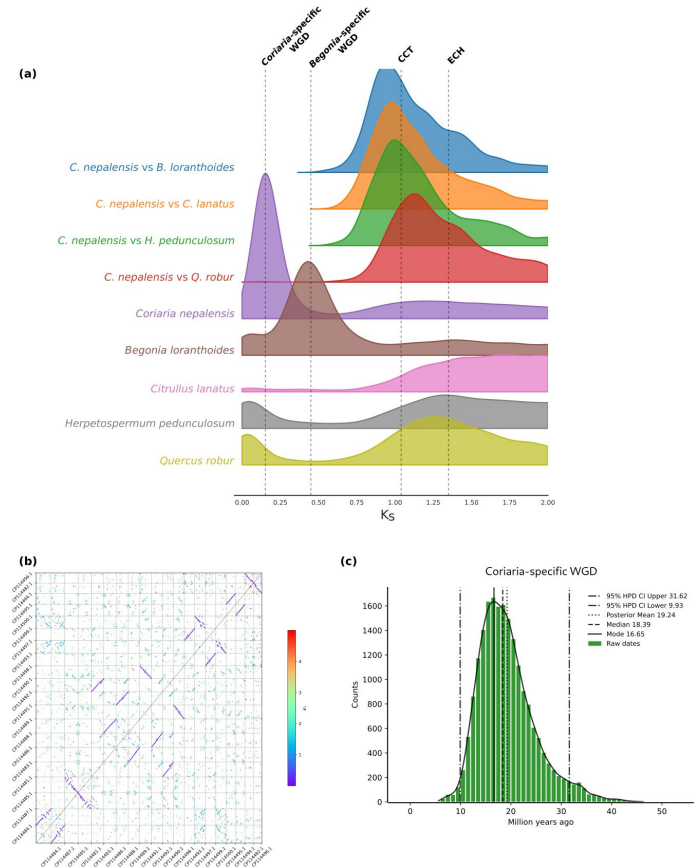
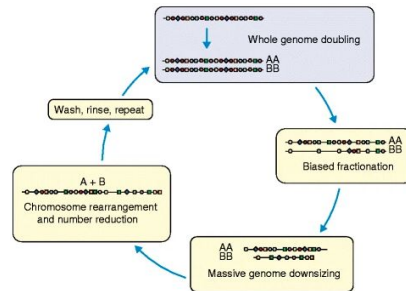


-

- Analysis of the evolutionary relationships between sequences/species
- Reconstruction of possible models to explain these relationships
- Not limited to sequence similarity, but considered (most likely) ancestral stages



- Genomes evolve over time
- Whole genome duplication is crucial source for new sequences in plants
- Polyploidy = multiple copies of all chromosomes
- Transposable Elements (TEs) can increase genome size
- Huge differences in chromosome numbers and genome sizes



Do you know any bioinformatics tools?

Required
subject

No file chosen

seqtype

pep ▼

Optional
scoreratio

0.3

simcut

0.4

minsim

0.4

minres

0.0

minreg

0.0

possibilities

3

Privacy

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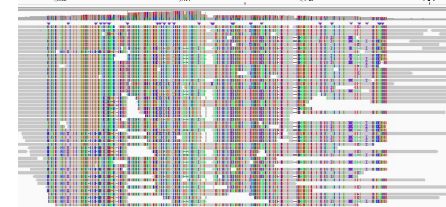
Reset

Submit

Types of bioinformatics tools

- Command line: require a basic understanding of Linux, but allow the processing of large data sets
 - Example: long read-based t-DNA analysis (Ioreta); <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12864-021-07877-8>
- Graphical user interface (GUI): easier to use, but usually restricted to smaller data sets
 - Example: Integrated Genome Viewer (IGV), <https://igv.org/>
- Web services: easy to use, but usually restricted to small data sets
 - Example: Knowledge-Based Identification of Pathway Enzymes (KIPes); <http://pbb-tools.de/KIPes>

`samtools view -S -b sample.sam > sample.bam`



KIPes (Knowledge-based Identification of Pathway Enzymes)

Required input

seqtype

Optional scenarios

Privacy

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Plant Biotechnology and Bioinformatics (Prof. Pucker)

News

Research

Bioinformatics

Team

Publications

Projects for students

Teaching

IGEM

Open Positions

Contact

Bioinformatics

KIPes

WTF_annotator

How to run command line tools

- Trimmomatic:

<http://www.usadellab.org/cms/?page=trimmomatic>

```
java -jar <path to trimmomatic jar> SE [-threads <threads>] [-phred33 | -phred64] [-trimlog  
<logFile>] <input> <output> <step 1> ...
```

- Samtools:

<http://www.htslib.org/doc/samtools-view.html>

```
samtools view -S -b sample.sam > sample.bam
```

Do you know any programming languages?

string integer float
float list dict
sorted key value
def function print
else elif

Script and programming languages

- Perl: one of the first script languages used in bioinformatics (sequences)
 - Examples: AUGUSTUS and helper scripts
 - <https://www.perlfoundation.org/>
- Python: established script language for bioinformatics (sequences)
 - Examples: BUSCO, KIPes, MYB_annotator
 - <https://www.python.org/psf/>
- Julia: script language that is gaining attention (structures)
 - Examples: biojulia
 - <https://julialang.org/>
- R: established script language for bioinformatics (numbers/statistics)
 - Examples: DESeq2, ggplot2,
 - <https://www.r-project.org/about.html>
- Java: powerful for the analysis of large data sets
 - Integrated Genomics Viewer (IGV), SnpEff, samtools, Trimmomatic, ...
 - <https://www.java.com/de/> (commercial)

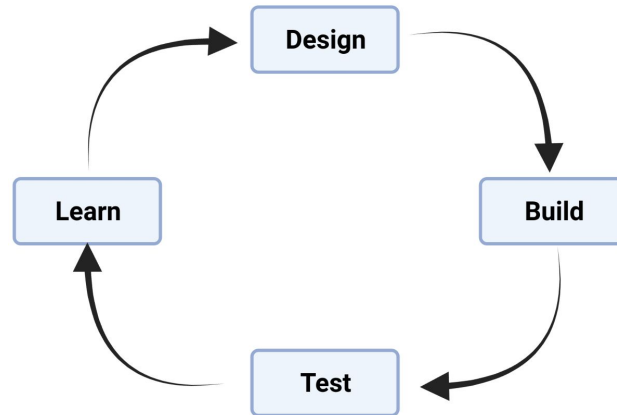


How would you optimize a bioinformatics tool?



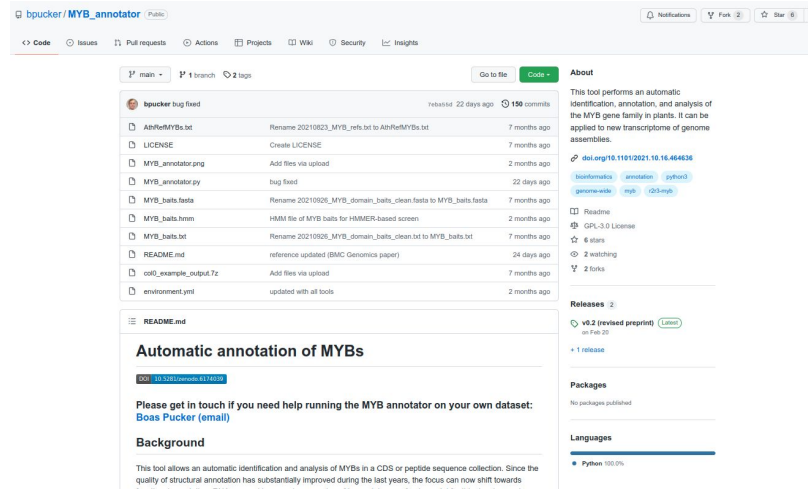
Design-Build-Test-Learn Cycle

- Software (any product) can be improved through the DBTL cycle:
 - Design how the software could work
 - Build the software according to the design
 - Test how well the software performs
 - Learn from the testing and start again with an improved design



Version control and repositories

- Version control is important when improving successively
- Different version control systems:
 - Git, CVS, SVN, ...
- Online repositories that allow sharing of code:
 - GitHub, Bitbucket, GitLab, SourceForge, ...



- MIT: leanest licence (everything is possible)
- Apache: similar to MIT, but lengthy
- GPL (General Public License): ensures that derived work remains open
- BSD (Berkeley Software Distribution): similar to MIT, but more cases specified

MIT License

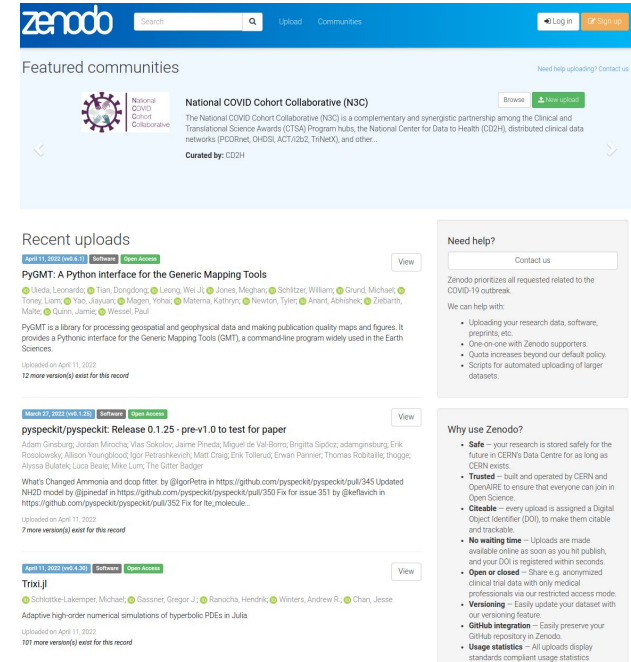
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- Data permanently stored in CERN's data centre
- OpenAIRE allows everyone to engage in OpenScience
 - socio-technical infrastructure for scholarly communication
- DOI makes entries citeable
- Uploads are published immediately
- Integration with GitHub possible



The screenshot shows the Zenodo website interface. At the top is a blue header with the Zenodo logo, a search bar, and links for 'Upload', 'Communities', 'Log in', and 'Sign up'. Below the header, the 'Featured communities' section highlights the 'National COVID Cohort Collaborative (N3C)' with a brief description and a 'Browse' button. The 'Recent uploads' section lists three items: 'PyGMT: A Python interface for the Generic Mapping Tools', 'pyspeckit/pyspeckit: Release 0.1.25 - pre-v1.0 to test for paper', and 'Trixi.jl'. Each item includes a 'View' button and a link to '12 more version(s) exist for this record'. The right sidebar contains two sections: 'Need help?' with a 'Contact us' button and a description of Zenodo's mission, and 'Why use Zenodo?' which lists seven benefits: Safe, Trusted, Open or closed, Citable, No waiting time, Adaptive high-order numerical simulations, and GitHub integration.

- International open-access repository
- Suitable for large data sets, but also an option for software
- CC0 licence makes everything completely re-useable by other
- DOIs make entries citeable



- Bioinformatic tools often have dependencies
- Dependency = module/tool that needs to be installed already
- Conda enables installation without administrator privileges



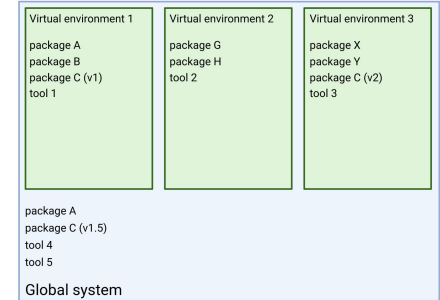
Package, dependency and environment management for any language—Python, R, Ruby, Lua, Scala, Java, JavaScript, C/ C++, FORTRAN, and more.

Conda is an open source package management system and environment management system that runs on Windows, macOS and Linux. Conda quickly installs, runs and updates packages and their dependencies. Conda easily creates, saves, loads and switches between environments on your local computer. It was created for Python programs, but it can package and distribute software for any language.

Conda as a package manager helps you find and install packages. If you need a package that requires a different version of Python, you do not need to switch to a different environment manager, because conda is also an environment manager. With just a few commands, you can set up a totally separate environment to run that different version of Python, while continuing to run your usual version of Python in your normal environment.

In its default configuration, conda can install and manage the thousand packages at repo.anaconda.com that are built, reviewed and maintained by Anaconda®.

- Virtual environment allows controlled installation of tools without interfering with system
- Tool and all dependencies are installed in a box
- Different versions of packages/modules are required for different tools
- Different virtual environments can be used for different tools



12.2. Creating Virtual Environments

The module used to create and manage virtual environments is called `venv`. `venv` will usually install the most recent version of Python that you have available. If you have multiple versions of Python on your system, you can select a specific Python version by running `python3` or whichever version you want.

To create a virtual environment, decide upon a directory where you want to place it, and run the `venv` module as a script with the directory path:

```
python3 -m venv tutorial-env
```

This will create the `tutorial-env` directory if it doesn't exist, and also create directories inside it containing a copy of the Python interpreter and various supporting files.

A common directory location for a virtual environment is `.venv`. This name keeps the directory typically hidden in your shell and thus out of the way while giving it a name that explains why the directory exists. It also prevents clashing with `.env` environment variable definition files that some tooling supports.

Once you've created a virtual environment, you may activate it.

On Windows, run:

```
tutorial-env\Scripts\activate.bat
```

On Unix or MacOS, run:

```
source tutorial-env/bin/activate
```

(This script is written for the bash shell. If you use the `csh` or `fish` shells, there are alternate `activate.csh` and `activate.fish` scripts you should use instead.)

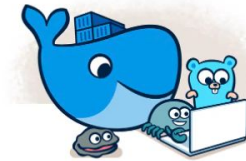
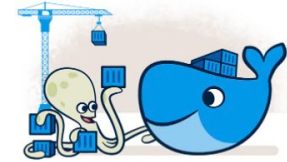
Activating the virtual environment will change your shell's prompt to show what virtual environment you're using, and modify the environment so that running `python` will get you that particular version and installation of Python. For example:

```
$ source ~/envs/tutorial-env/bin/activate
(tutorial-env) $ python
Python 3.5.1 (default, May 6 2016, 10:50:36)
...
>>> import sys
>>> sys.path
['.', '/usr/local/lib/python3.5.zip', ...,
~/envs/tutorial-env/lib/python3.5/site-packages']
>>>
```

- Solution to prepare an environment for running tools
- Build: developer of tool generates an image of the required environment
- Share: image is shared with users of the tool
- Run: user can mount the image to run a tool in a defined environment
- Alternatives: podman, OpenVZ, VirtualBox, Kubernetes, LXC, ZeroVM, ...

Build

- Get a head start on your coding by leveraging Docker images to efficiently develop your own unique applications on Windows and Mac. Create your multi-container application using Docker Compose.
- Integrate with your favorite tools throughout your development pipeline – Docker works with all development tools you use including VS Code, CircleCI and GitHub.
- Package applications as portable container images to run in any environment consistently from on-premises Kubernetes to AWS ECS, Azure ACI, Google GKE and more.



Share

- Leverage Docker Trusted Content, including Docker Official Images and images from Docker Verified Publishers from the Docker Hub repository.
- Innovate by collaborating with team members and other developers and by easily publishing images to Docker Hub.
- Personalize developer access to images with roles based access control and get insights into activity history with Docker Hub Audit Logs.

Run

- Deliver multiple applications hassle free and have them run the same way on all your environments including design, testing, staging and production – desktop or cloud-native.
- Deploy your applications in separate containers independently and in different languages. Reduce the risk of conflict between languages, libraries or frameworks.
- Speed development with the simplicity of Docker Compose CLI and with one command, launch your applications locally and on the cloud with AWS ECS and Azure ACI.



- Graphical user interface (web-based platform) for bioinformatic workflows
- Open source enables local installation (e.g. on compute cluster)
- Supported by de.NBI, elixir, and many others

Galaxy is an open source, web-based platform for data intensive biomedical research. If you are new to Galaxy start here or consult our help resources. You can install your own Galaxy by following the tutorial and choose from thousands of tools from the Tool Shed.



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	Early registration ends	Poster/demo abstracts due	Full registration ends

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The Galaxy Team is a part of the Center for Comparative Genomics and Bioinformatics at Penn State, the Department of Biology at Johns Hopkins University and the Computational Biology Program at Oregon Health & Science University.

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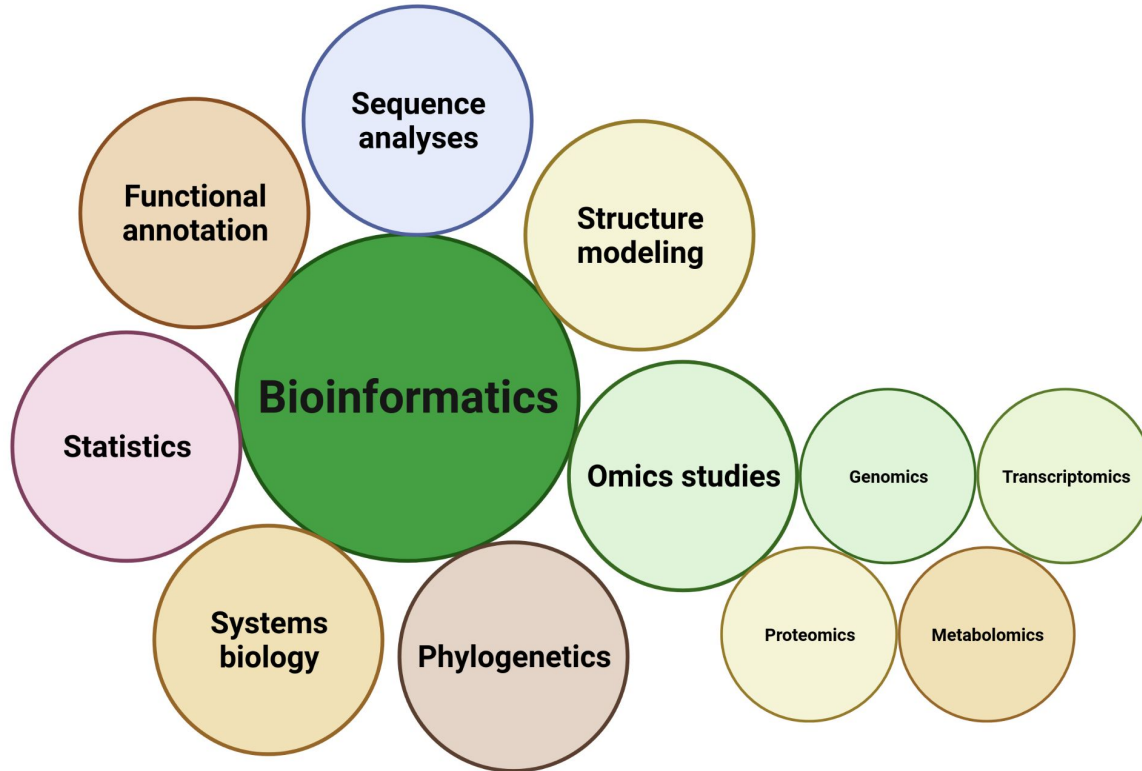
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- German Network for Bioinformatics Infrastructure Service, Training, Cooperations & Cloud Computing
- Centrally funded support for bioinformatic analyses in Germany
- Almost 100 tools provided and supported by de.NBI
- Training events for next generation scientists
- de.NBI cloud enables researchers in Germany to conduct bioinformatics research



- Intergovernmental organisation of life scientists and computer scientists in Europe
- Provides resources for European life scientists
- 23 ELIXIR nodes in different countries
- EMBL-EBI heads ELIXIR
- de.NBI is German ELIXIR node





Time for questions!

1. Which fields are part of bioinformatics?
2. What is the definition of a genome, transcriptome, proteome, and metabolome?
3. What is the full name of 'BLAST'?
4. Which (sequencing) method can be used to analyze a genome?
5. Which method can be used to analyze a transcriptome?
6. Why do biologists apply statistical methods?
7. Which languages are used for the development of bioinformatics tools?
8. Which steps are involved in software development/improvement?
9. Which platforms enable developers to share their software?
10. Which licence can be used to make software freely available to other researchers?
11. Where can you find (online) computational resources for bioinformatics?